



Traditional Advertising

Building Local Trust with Offline Marketing

Introduction to Traditional Advertising

This lesson introduces traditional advertising as one of the original and still-effective forms of paid marketing for real estate investors. Print ads in newspapers, local programs, bulletins, and physical displays offer a trusted, offline way to connect with homeowners—especially those not active online.

You'll learn why this method still works, where to place your ads for visibility, and how to keep it simple and budget-friendly—even as a beginner.

What to Expect and How It Works

This lesson covers:

- What traditional advertising is and why it works
 - Where to place ads for maximum exposure
 - How much time and money it typically takes
 - How to create a high-trust message without needing tech
 - How to track your results and measure effectiveness
 - A challenge to test your own traditional ad locally
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Why Traditional Ads Still Work

- Highly trusted by older homeowners and those not active online
- Creates legitimacy and community visibility
- Reaches readers where digital ads can't—offline, in-hand, and in print
- Builds brand familiarity over time

 Example: A homeowner reading a weekly church bulletin recognizes your number from an ad they've seen for weeks—and finally picks up the phone.

Average Time and Money Investment

- Newspaper ads: \$50–\$300 depending on size and placement
- Event programs and bulletins: \$25–\$200
- Billboards: \$300–\$2,000+ per month (based on traffic and location)



- Ad design (optional): \$50–\$200 for a freelancer or design agency
- Total time: 2–5 hours to design, coordinate, and submit ads

This is an affordable, low-tech method that works well for small budgets.

No Tech? No Problem

- Submit ads via email, or drop them off in person
- Talk directly with bulletin editors, program directors, or ad managers
- Use Canva for free designs, or hire help via Fiverr for \$10–\$25
- Focus on showing up in your community—not mastering tech

 Traditional ads succeed when you combine clarity with consistency.

Hiring an Advertising Company

- Look for local firms or freelancers who've worked with real estate ads
- Ask for samples, timelines, and flat-rate packages
- Use custom tracking: dedicated phone numbers, QR codes, or unique URLs
- Measure ROI by logging which ad placements generate real calls

 Knowing your numbers helps you spend smarter next time.

What a Good Traditional Ad Includes

- Bold headline that addresses a seller's pain point
- Local phone number or simple web link
- Optional: logo, small photo, or “locally owned” message
- Focus on clarity over creativity

Examples:

“We Buy Houses Fast – Call (555) 123-4567”

“Sell As-Is – No Repairs Needed – Call Now!”

Best Places to Place Traditional Ads

- ✓ Bulletin boards at coffee shops and small businesses
- ✓ School and church programs
- ✓ Local event flyers and sports team sponsorships



- ✓ Community lifestyle magazines
- ✓ Weekly newspapers and classified sections
- ✓ Local shopper guides and real estate circulars
- ✓ Billboards, bus stops, and benches near key zip codes

Choose locations where your ideal sellers already live, shop, and read.

Key Takeaways

- Traditional ads are trusted, affordable, and still work in many local markets
 - They are ideal for reaching offline sellers and older property owners
 - No tech is required—just a clear message and a willingness to show up
 - Tracking results lets you test what works and improve over time
 - One good placement can build momentum and authority in your community
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Student Challenge – Your Traditional Ad Placement

Try this in the next 1–2 weeks:

- Choose one ad platform: newspaper, bulletin board, flyer, or small magazine
- Write a clear headline and simple offer
- Include a phone number and call to action
- Place your ad and track calls or messages that come in
- Record where and when the ad ran and what results you saw

 One local ad could lead to one local deal. Show up—and start the momentum.